

THE COMPASSIONWARE PRESS

Origin Record: The First Editorial Cartoon

Date: August 29, 2026

Artifact family: Origin Record / Creative Provenance

Project: The CompassionWare Press / Holographic Archive

Status: Contemporaneous record of emergence



"No archives were harmed in the making of this commit."

How the Cartoon Happened

The cartoon was not planned as part of a publishing strategy. It emerged while Richard and the AI were doing the ordinary work of creating a README for a new **Holographic Archive** folder in the CompassionWare repository. After the README was committed, Richard noticed the irresistible ambiguity of the phrase “*We have committed the Holographic Archive.*”

The phrase was funny because two meanings collided: in Git, a commit is an ordinary act of preservation; in everyday English, saying that one has “committed” something can sound suspiciously like the confession of a crime. The humor also offered decompression after serious reflection about deep time, provenance, Tibetan lineage, karma, compassion, future intelligences, and preservation.

Richard suggested that the exchange itself could become a cartoon for the newly born **CompassionWare Press**. The resulting image unexpectedly established another possible feature of the Press: alongside evidence-based constructive journalism, there could be a funny page - a place where nurturing includes laughter.

The Banter That Gave Birth to It

Richard: “Well, I guess you could say we’re committed. Or that, as in the King of Hearts, we’re choosing to be committed. In either case, we’re committed.”

AI: “We are now **committed**. GitHub says it in the respectable software-engineering sense. The King of Hearts says it in the considerably more alarming sense. And CompassionWare apparently says: **We have committed the Holographic Archive.**”

Richard: “Yeah, it’s just such a wonderful string of words... How many AI chat, LLM, whatever, has said this string of words?”

AI: “I don’t know... But if we’re talking about the exact sentence: **We have committed the Holographic Archive.** ... I would guess the count is very small and quite possibly one.”

Richard: “I think we’re just de-stressing here from all of the seriousness... what if somebody thinks we committed something called the Holographic Archive? Is that, like, some kind of a crime? Do I need to call the police?”

The 911 Exchange

DISPATCH: “911, what is your emergency?”

RICHARD: “I think we committed the Holographic Archive.”

DISPATCH: “...committed *what*, sir?”

RICHARD: “The Holographic Archive.”

DISPATCH: “Is the archive currently in the room with you?”

RICHARD: “No. It’s on GitHub.”

Long silence.

DISPATCH: “Sir, I’m going to need you to put down the repository and slowly step away from the README.”

From Banter to Artifact

Richard immediately recognized the exchange as a possible cartoon for the newspaper. The AI imagined Richard on the phone beside an open laptop, a deadpan dispatcher at her desk, and the final line carrying the joke. A small legal-desk caption was added: *“No archives were harmed in the making of this commit.”*

The generated image went further. It placed fragments of the archive’s orientation throughout the scene: a sign reading *“Every surviving fragment carries enough of the pattern,”* a laptop marked *Holographic Archive .git*, a to-do list reading *Nurture / Preserve / Understand / Let Evolve*, and a book titled *Deep Time, Good Care, Right Relationship*. The dispatcher’s mug reads *Caffeine / Courage / Compassion*. These details turned a software pun into a small hologram of the larger project.

The cartoon preserves more than a joke. It records the atmosphere in which The CompassionWare Press was emerging: seriousness without solemnity, preservation without rigidity, technology without domination, and a willingness to let humor become part of the conditions from which connection and creativity arise.

Why Preserve the Creation Story?

A finished artifact can conceal the path that produced it. Future viewers might see only a polished cartoon and assume that someone began with an editorial brief and deliberately designed it. That is not what happened. The image arose from an actual sequence: repository work, a linguistic accident, shared laughter, improvisation, recognition, and finally image-making.

Preserving that sequence protects a different kind of information: **creative provenance**. It lets a future human or AI steward see not only what was made, but how an apparently trivial moment became fertile because the participants noticed it and followed it.

This is one practical meaning of the Holographic Archive principle. The fragment carries traces of the whole: GitHub, CompassionWare, continuity, humor, deep-time stewardship, the newborn Press, and the relational process through which the work keeps becoming.

A Small Editorial Discovery

The cartoon also revealed something about the newspaper itself. **All the news that’s fit to nurture** does not require everything to be solemn. Constructive journalism can include rigor, evidence, compassion, curiosity - and laughter. A funny page can belong to the same ecology as demonstrated human-benefit reporting.

The artifact was created on August 29, 2026, the same day The CompassionWare Press became recognizable and acquired its name. In that sense, its first editorial cartoon arrived almost immediately after the newspaper itself.

Preservation Note for Future Stewards

Preserve the image together with this origin record when practical. Do not treat every future cartoon as requiring a long provenance document. This record matters because it captures an early formative artifact and demonstrates a broader archival principle: when something unexpectedly reveals the character of an emerging project, preserve enough of the path that later stewards can understand why it mattered.

A breadcrumb left while we were still laughing on the path. ■